

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

The Thoughtful Gift Guide for Ages 2–4

Fewer, better gifts · And how to ask family

Fewer toys lead to deeper play. Use this guide to suggest gifts to relatives, or to choose your own.

What the research found

- ○ Toddlers with 4 toys available played longer and in more varied ways than toddlers with 16 (Dauch et al., 2018).

Experience gifts

- ○ A zoo, aquarium or farm visit
- ○ A train or boat ride
- ○ A special day out with a grandparent
- ○ Swimming or music classes

Toys that last

- ○ Wooden blocks
- ○ A child-sized kitchen tool set
- ○ Simple puzzles
- ○ Picture books
- ○ Art supplies: crayons, paper, play dough

How to ask family kindly

- ○ “She's loving books right now, would you like to give her one?”
- ○ “Instead of a toy, could you take him to the park? He'd love that.”

After the festival

Keep 2–3 new gifts out and store the rest. Bring one out every few weeks.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Dauch, C., Imwalle, M., Ocasio, B., & Metz, A. E. (2018). The influence of the number of toys in the environment on toddlers' play. Infant Behavior and Development, 50, 78–87.

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